

The Complete Guide

The whole system on one page, and where the next thing goes.

SEVEN PIECES, EACH DOING A JOB THE OTHERS CANNOT

PIECE	WHAT IT IS FOR	DAY
<code>CLAUDE.md</code>	Facts that are always true	2
<code>.claude/rules/</code>	Facts true only for some files	12
Memory	What it learned by itself	4
<code>.claude/skills/</code>	Procedures you repeat	9, 15, 19
<code>.claude/agents/</code>	Narrow jobs, with tools taken away	21
<code>.claude/hooks/</code>	Things that must or must never happen	8, 11
Connections	Live data behind a login	16

WHERE A NEW THING GOES. FIRST YES WINS

- **Must it happen, or must it never happen?** A hook.
- **Is it a fact that is always true?** `CLAUDE.md`. True only for some files? A rule with a path filter.
- **Is it a procedure with steps?** A skill.
- **Is it a narrow job that should not have all the tools?** An agent.

THE ONE TO GET RIGHT

If something genuinely must not happen, it is a hook, not an instruction. A written rule is guidance and is usually followed. A hook is enforcement and always runs.

THE SIX QUESTION SELF CHECK

- Which piece stops something happening, rather than asking for it?
- Where does a fact that is only true for test files belong?
- What is the difference between what you write and what it writes?
- Why is an unused connection not free?
- What does exit code 2 do?
- What must never be in any of these files?

THE CLEAR-OUT, WHICH IS THE REAL WORK OF DAY 30

Be ready for the answer. A third of it has probably never been run

Look at everything in my `.claude/` folder and my `CLAUDE.md`.

For each skill, agent, hook and rule tell me: what it does
in one line, whether there is any sign I have used it,
and
whether it duplicates something else.

Then tell me what to delete. Be blunt.

Delete anything unused for a month. It is in your history if you want it back, and a short setup you understand beats a long one you have to think about.